Lion -- Elevation Worship (CCM / Modern Worship)

HSS Stratocaster. Full board.
Album-level build, modeled on the overall guitar approach across Elevation Worship's *Lion* (2022) and their wider catalog -- the modern CCM "wall of sound": ambient, heavily modulated clean tones under verses, swelling into a bigger, saturated anthem tone for choruses and lead lines, all of it soaked in delay and reverb the whole time.
That wash never goes away between the two states -- only the gain does. That's the core design decision here: MOD/DLY/RVB/EQ and the amp/cab stay fixed and always on, CTL only swaps the gain stages.

GP-5 Settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB

AMP -- Foxy 30TB (always on)
- Gain: 32, Tone Cut: 40, VOL: 60, Bass: 45, Treble: 62, Char: Cool
- The GP-5's model of the Vox AC30HW Top Boost channel. Modern worship lives on a chimey AC30.
- Gain 32: clean with a little edge. The Boost, Green OD and King of Kings supply the anthem gain.
- Tone Cut 40 and Treble 62: bright and chimey. The EQ's 3kHz/6kHz lift adds the shimmer on top.
- Bass 45: a little lean, so it doesn't fight bass and pads.
- Char Cool: the cleaner of the two voicings. Hot would pile more gain under the OD stack.
- Moved off the WorshipAC30 snaptone 2026-10-01. Michael dropped the AC30 NAMs until a better one turns up, so this uses the GP-5's own AC30 model.
- Same in both CTL states.

CAB -- User IR 10: V30112 (always on)
- VOL: 60
- Celestion V30 1x12 IR from the loaded set, the same cab as the other Elevation Worship patches (Praise). It's tight and mid-forward, so it cuts through a dense worship mix.
- Same in both CTL states.

NR -- Gate
- THRE: 20
- Always on. Light -- this patch lives on long decaying swells and delay/reverb tails, so the gate can't be aggressive enough to chop them off.

PRE -- Boost (Xotic EP Booster)
- Gain: 60, +3dB: On, Bright: On
- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- The "size" switch for the anthem state -- clean, transparent volume/edge boost that pushes the amp and DST harder without adding its own character. Off for the ambient rhythm sound, on for the lead/chorus lift.

DST -- Green OD (Tube Screamer / TS-808)
- Gain: 40, Tone: 60, VOL: 65

- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- Moderate, not metal -- this is the smooth, singing mid-gain crunch that defines the modern worship "anthem" guitar tone, not a rock distortion. Off for rhythm, on for lead, stacking with the Boost and the King of Kings right channel (see pedalboard) for the full swell.

EQ -- Guitar EQ 2
- 100Hz: -3, 500Hz: -2, 1kHz: 0, 3kHz: +4, 6kHz: +5, VOL: 50
- Always on. Low end trimmed so the guitar doesn't fight bass/pads in a dense worship mix; slight 500Hz cut to keep it out of the boxy zone; 3kHz/6kHz lifted for the airy, cutting shimmer that sits on top of a big band mix without needing raw volume.

MOD -- A-Chorus (Arion SCH-1)
- Depth: 55, Rate: 0.6Hz, Tone: 60
- Loads on, both CTL states. MIDI toggle: loads on, can be switched off (see MIDI toggles). Heavier than this workflow's usual light-touch MOD default -- deliberately, because a drenched, obvious chorus shimmer is the whole point of this style, not an accident. This is doing a lot of the "ambient wall" work by itself.

DLY -- Tape
- Mix: 35, Time: 450ms, F.Back: 35, Trail: On
- Loads on, both CTL states. MIDI toggle: loads on, can be switched off (see MIDI toggles). Long, warm, saturated repeats -- this genre's guitar sound is inseparable from delay. Same delay under both the quiet rhythm parts and the big lead swells, which is exactly how these records are built.

RVB -- Sweet Space
- Mix: 40, Decay: 70, Damp: 40, Mod: 35, Trail: On
- Always on, both CTL states. Long, modulated, spacious reverb -- the Mod parameter adds a subtle shimmer/movement to the tail that's very characteristic of this modern-CCM ambient sound. This is the "room" the whole track lives in.

CTL Summary (GP-5)
- **CTL Off -- Rhythm (verses, ambient sections):** Clean, chimey AC30 tone, no PRE boost, no drive. The wash (chorus/delay/reverb) carries the sound. This is the main texture of the patch.
- **CTL On -- Lead (choruses, anthem sections):** Boost + Green OD both kick in on top of the same amp/cab/wash, pushing into a bigger, saturated, sustained tone -- same ambient character, just louder and driven. Pair with the King of Kings right channel for the full swell.

MIDI toggles

MIDI = True (added 2026-10-12). With no MIDI controller connected, the patch loads and plays exactly as before: CTL and the board work the same. MIDI adds single-block toggles on top.

On MIDI: PRE (Boost), DST (Green OD), MOD (A-Chorus), DLY (Tape). PRE and DST are also on CTL. MOD and DLY are MIDI-only and load on.

Sounds:

- **Clean wash** (default). CTL off, all MIDI blocks as loaded. Verses and ambient sections.
- **Driven rhythm.** CTL off, MIDI DST on. The Green OD alone, no boost: mid-gain strummed rhythm for second verses and builds, before the anthem.
- **Dry tight strum.** CTL off, MIDI DLY off, MIDI MOD off. Rhythmic strumming and up-tempo songs where the wash smears the groove.
- **Anthem lead** (CTL on). Boost + Green OD over the full wash. Choruses and anthem sections.
- **Soft lead.** CTL on, MIDI PRE off. The Green OD without the boost: a quieter, smoother lead for bridges and intimate melody lines.

Full Pedalboard (signal chain order)

1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- Engaged, light shimmer layer, whole song.

- +OCT: 25, all other octave knobs (-2OCT, -OCT, +2OCT): 0
- Dry: 80

A subtle octave-up layer underneath the dry signal -- this is a real Elevation Worship production trick, a quiet shimmer pad sitting under the clean arpeggios. Kept low enough (+OCT 25) that it reads as texture, not a separate voice. Since it's polyphonic and best on sustained material, it works well here because this patch is built around sustained chords and swells, not fast lead runs.

2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- Engaged, whole song.

- COMP: 50
- TONE: 55
- LEVEL: 55
- Mode: NORMAL

Evens out dynamics for sustained ambient swells -- critical for this style, where notes need to bloom and hold evenly under all that delay/reverb. NORMAL mode (not TREBLE) because the EQ module and MOD/DLY/RVB chain already add plenty of top end; stacking more brightness pre-drive would get harsh once the Boost/Green OD kick in.

3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- Bypassed, whole song.

Not a fuzz style -- the anthem lift comes from smooth, singing overdrive (Boost + Green OD + King of Kings), not garage fuzz character. True bypass throughout.

4. Joyo King of Kings -- Left channel engaged whole song, Right channel engaged only for CTL On / lead sections.

Left channel (always on -- low-gain glue):

- Volume: 55
- Gain: 20
- Tone: 55
- Clipping toggle: softer setting
- Feedback toggle: standard setting

A quiet, always-on push that adds warmth and a little extra harmonic content under the clean ambient tone --

very common in modern worship rigs, an always-on low-gain stage that "glues" the tone even before anything else engages.

Right channel (CTL On / lead only):
- Volume: 65
- Gain: 55
- Tone: 60
- Clipping toggle: harder setting
- Feedback toggle: higher setting

Stacks with the left channel, the GP-5's Boost, and Green OD for the full anthem swell -- this is the extra saturation and sustain that makes the chorus/lead sections feel huge without turning harsh. Step on together with the GP-5 CTL switch.

5. Joyo Narcissus -- Bypassed, whole song.
The GP-5's own A-Chorus (always on) is the primary chorus/shimmer voice for this patch, already pushed harder than usual on purpose. Stacking a second chorus pedal on top would turn the wash to mud. True bypass throughout.

6. Valeton GP-5 -- as detailed above.

Footswitch Choreography

- **Rhythm / verses / ambient sections:** GP-5 CTL off, King of Kings right channel off. Comp and Octave shimmer running underneath the whole time.
- **Chorus / lead / anthem sections:** GP-5 CTL on (engages PRE Boost + Green OD together) at the same moment you step on the King of Kings right channel. All three come off together when dropping back to a verse/rhythm section.
- Fuzz and Narcissus stay bypassed for the entire patch -- the wash comes from the GP-5's own MOD/DLY/RVB, not from stacking extra modulation/fuzz pedals.